

Command words

The table below includes command words used in the assessment for this syllabus.

Command word	What it means
Assess	Make an informed judgement.
Calculate	Work out from given facts, figures or information.
Compare	Identify/comment on similarities and/or differences.
Define	Give precise meaning.
Describe	State the points of a topic/give characteristics and main features.
Devise	Create a questionnaire to present other information according to specific requirements.
Discuss	Write about issue(s) or topic(s) in depth in a structured way.
Estimate	Use judgement to give a unit value to a distance or area.
Evaluate	Judge or calculate the quality, importance, amount or value of something.
Explain	Set out purposes or reasons/make the relationships between things clear/say why and/or how and support with relevant evidence.
Give	Produce an answer from a given source or recall/memory.
Identify	Name/select/recognise.
Justify	Support a case with evidence/argument.
Locate	Indicate the position of a place, feature or entity from/in a resource.
Plan	Create a method to obtain or present certain information (such as a questionnaire) according to specific requirements.
Plot	Mark point(s) on a graph/diagram/map.
Predict	Suggest what may happen based on available information.
Sketch	Make a simple freehand drawing showing the key features, taking care over proportions.
State	Express in clear terms.
Suggest	Apply knowledge and understanding to situations where there are a range of valid responses in order to make proposals/put forward considerations.

Phrases such as ‘How far do you agree...?’ and ‘To what extent...?’ may also be seen in the assessment of this syllabus.

The information in this section is taken from the Cambridge International Education syllabus. You should always refer to the appropriate syllabus document for the year of examination to confirm the details and for more information. The syllabus document is available on the website: www.cambridgeinternational.org.